
**Section B: theatre
design skills**

Student will:

- contribute to a production of a complete and substantial play text chosen and cast by the tutor
- work collaboratively with a production company and director
- prepare the appropriate design skills chosen and complete for performance
- complete chosen skill in production to an appropriate audience and the visiting examiner
- give a presentation of no more than 10 minutes to the visiting examiner prior to the performance
- prepare in advance a written design concept.

2.4 Delivering this unit

Suitability of play texts

It is the responsibility of the centre to choose or give clear guidance to students on the suitability of the play texts used in performance. All texts must be professionally published, substantial and have the degree of challenge to enable students to achieve at AS level. Plays in translation are perfectly acceptable as are contemporary texts as long as a published text is available.

All students will be examined in performance and texts should be chosen that would facilitate achievement in performance. The literary merit of a play may not, necessarily, be the prime reason for the choice of a text. Texts should be chosen that offer students the opportunity to exhibit their acting or design skills that are the essential object of assessment. Centres should consider the skills, experience and prior learning of students in choosing texts that will engage students' interest throughout the considerable preparation and rehearsal time needed for this unit.

Edexcel will give no approval for the texts chosen. Centres must ensure the suitability of the texts for students and audiences.

Candidates should be placed in performance groups where they will be given the opportunity to achieve their full potential. Teachers will need to adopt a grouping policy that is most suitable for their students.

Copyright note

It must be understood that the performance and the recording of the performance are for examination purposes only. Any performances or recordings of performances undertaken by centres outside of the context of the examination must seek copyright permission for works in copyright. Any work written or translated by an author who is living or who died less than 70 years ago will almost certainly be subject to a performing and/or recording royalty. The copyright act only allows exemptions where work is performed and recorded for the purposes of assessment in an examination context.

Performance roles and design skills

- In Section A students may only offer one role or theatre design skill.
- In Section B students may take on one or more roles or theatre design options.

All work must be performed to an appropriate audience of which the examiner is the most important member. The performance is an examination and must take place under appropriate examination conditions.

This section requires students to undertake individual research and preparation with guidance throughout by the tutor.

Written design concepts and written performance concepts must be completed under supervised conditions.

Where students are offering one design skill then the evidence required is defined on the grid on the following page. Students who offer more than one design skill in Section B must produce, as a minimum, the evidence listed in the shaded area of the grid.

In Section A, students are required to demonstrate in performance at least one lighting change/aspect of set/costume/mask/makeup/sound cue, although in their documentation they must be able to produce all of the evidence for their chosen skill listed on the following page.